

Title: Social Media Use and Its Relationship with Academic Stress Among College Students

Background of the Study

Social media has become part of the daily routine of many college students. Students use platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, X, and Messenger for communication, entertainment, academic updates, and social interaction. While social media can help students stay connected and informed, excessive use may also affect their focus, sleep, time management, and emotional well-being.

Academic stress is common among college students because of deadlines, exams, group projects, performance expectations, and personal responsibilities. Some students use social media as a way to relax or escape stress, while others may feel more stressed because of distractions, comparison with others, or fear of missing out. Because of this, it is important to examine how social media use is related to academic stress.

This study aims to determine the relationship between social media use and academic stress among college students. It will focus on frequency of use, purpose of use, time spent online, and perceived effects on academic responsibilities.

Statement of the Problem

The main problem addressed by this study is the possible connection between social media use and academic stress. While social media may provide emotional support and entertainment, it may also contribute to procrastination, reduced productivity, and increased pressure. This study seeks to understand whether higher social media use is associated with higher levels of academic stress.

Research Objectives

This study aims to:

1. Determine the frequency and purpose of social media use among college students.
2. Assess the level of academic stress experienced by students.
3. Identify common stressors related to academic work.
4. Examine the relationship between social media use and academic stress.
5. Recommend healthy social media habits that may support student well-being.

Proposed Methodology

This study will use a descriptive correlational research design. A survey questionnaire will be distributed to selected college students. The questionnaire will ask about social media usage, time spent online, academic workload, stress levels, sleep habits, and coping strategies.

The data will be analyzed using descriptive statistics and correlation analysis. The study may also include open-ended questions to gather student experiences about how social media affects their academic life.

Expected Output

The expected output of this study is a report showing the relationship between social media use and academic stress. The study may identify whether students who spend more time on social media experience higher stress or whether social media is used mainly as a coping tool.

Significance of the Study

This study may benefit students by helping them become more aware of how social media habits affect their academic performance and mental well-being. It may also help schools design student wellness programs, digital well-being campaigns, and stress management activities.

Keywords

Social media use, academic stress, college students, mental health, student well-being, procrastination, coping strategies, digital behavior, emotional well-being, student life